

John Escobedo

QA & Accessibility Analyst | Section 508 & WCAG Testing (JAWS, NVDA) | Healthcare & Government Systems | Trilingual (English/Spanish/ASL)

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Austin, Texas

Summary: Quality assurance and accessibility analyst with 18+ years testing healthcare, government, and e-commerce systems, including six years on VA clinical applications where I led Section 508 compliance initiatives and performed hands-on JAWS and NVDA screen-reader validation. I built the QA function for a video interpreting platform serving Deaf and hard-of-hearing users, learning American Sign Language and Deaf cultural norms to shape testing around real user needs. Trilingual (English, Spanish, ASL) with an ASL certificate from Austin Community College. I test not only whether software functions, but whether it works for everyone who depends on it.

SKILLS

Accessibility & Inclusion: Section 508 & WCAG, JAWS & NVDA Screen Readers, Inclusive User Research, End-User Advocacy, Deaf Cultural Competency & ASL (Conversational)

Testing: Manual & Exploratory, Functional, Regression, UAT, Integration, Smoke & Sanity, End-to-End, Usability

Test Management: Test Strategy & Planning, Test Case Design, Requirements Traceability, Defect Triage & Root Cause Analysis, Release Go/No-Go & Risk Assessment, HIPAA Compliance

API & Platforms: REST & SOAP API Testing (Postman), .NET & Java Systems, Web Applications, Mobile (iOS/Android), Desktop (Windows/Mac/Linux), Cross-Browser & Cross-Platform Compatibility

Business Analysis: Requirements Elicitation, User Stories & Acceptance Criteria, Gap Analysis, Process Mapping, Functional Specifications, Stakeholder Management, Change Management

Leadership & Collaboration: Team Leadership & Mentoring, Scrum Master & Agile Transformation, SDLC, Process Standardization, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Remote & Distributed Teams

Tools & Technologies: JIRA (Admin) & Confluence, Xray & TestRail, GitHub & CI/CD Workflows, Chrome DevTools, SQL & JQL, JavaScript/HTML/CSS, Command Line

Office & Creative Software: Office 365 (Teams, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook), Google Workspace (Drive, Docs, Sheets), Adobe Creative Suite (Photoshop, Illustrator, After Effects), Canva, GIMP

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Tester (Volunteer)

Sharpee.net | Austin, TX (Remote)

March 2026 to Present

Performed exploratory testing on a new web application, found silent-failure bugs that scripted tests missed, and contributed fixes and documentation directly to the codebase.

- Ran end-to-end exploratory testing across browsers and platforms, validating full user workflows.
- Caught silent-failure bugs that scripted tests missed, including cases where the app returned blank responses with no error signal.
- Built a custom failure-report template so any reader, technical or not, could immediately see what broke.

Senior QA Test Lead | Quality Assurance Tester | Scrum Master

GeekSI | Tallahassee, FL

March 2019 to June 2025

Led QA, UAT, and requirements analysis across multiple VA healthcare projects, drove Agile process adoption, and served as SME for complex clinical modules.

- Became the go-to SME for the Traumatic Brain Injury module, running knowledge transfer sessions so cross-functional teams could navigate the clinical requirements.
- Drove the Waterfall-to-Agile transition, introducing code freeze and release-candidate practices that shifted teams from reactive firefighting to predictable delivery.
- Managed test cases, defects, requirements documentation, and project dashboards in JIRA and Confluence across 6+ years and multiple VA projects.
- Ran SOAP API testing on VA home loan .NET applications and REST API testing via Postman on Java healthcare modules, validating service queries, data contracts, and data integrity.
- Built and executed test strategies for VA clinical healthcare applications across .NET and Java, covering UAT, regression, integration, smoke, sanity, end-to-end, and 508 compliance.
- Conducted user acceptance testing during two separate periods, organizing the testers, creating the tests, and gathering the results.
- Led 508 compliance initiatives and performed hands-on JAWS and NVDA screen-reader validation on VA clinical interfaces, catching accessibility issues visual inspection misses.
- Partnered with automation engineers to validate Cucumber and Selenium scripts, catching requirement-to-execution gaps before tests went into rotation.
- Built requirements traceability documentation mapping every business need to test coverage across web, mainframe, and mobile.

Senior QA Test Lead | Quality Assurance Tester

EverlyWell | Austin, TX
June 2018 to October 2018

Established QA processes and JIRA workflows from the ground up for a health tech startup's secure patient portal, partnering with engineering and product leadership on release validation.

- As JIRA administrator, designed a unified workflow with custom issue types, permission schemes, notifications, and dashboards, giving engineering and product real-time visibility into release status.
- Defined the initial QA process and release validation criteria for a team shipping without formal quality gates, bringing predictability to a fast-moving startup.
- Assessed release risk and delivered go/no-go recommendations to product and engineering leadership, balancing speed to market with quality.
- Validated releases across major browsers and mobile devices, catching requirement gaps before production.

QA Test Lead | QA Analyst

YouScience | Austin, TX
July 2017 to June 2018

As sole QA, built quality processes and test infrastructure from zero for the flagship education assessment platform, earning trust with development and product teams.

- Introduced foundational quality practices, including version control discipline, release candidates, and structured validation, to a team shipping without formal QA process, integrating quality as a respected part of the SDLC.
- Created end-to-end test and product documentation covering procedures, requirements traceability, verification standards, and feature release notes.
- Standardized user story and acceptance criteria templates, reducing ambiguity between developers and QA and speeding up delivery.
- Owned end-to-end validation for the flagship web application, gating every release across browsers and mobile platforms.

QA Tester | QA Analyst

Luna Data Solutions | Austin, TX

May 2015 to May 2017

QA Analyst contracted to RetailMeNot, coordinating cross-team testing for high-visibility e-commerce launches and aligning test priorities with business needs.

- Coordinated QA across multiple teams for the gift card feature launch supporting a \$22M acquisition, aligning test priorities with leadership expectations.
- Built custom JavaScript tools to validate site-wide analytics implementation and data integrity across the product.
- Triaged live production issues under pressure, communicating status updates to leadership during outages.
- Partnered with developers to improve internal tooling and CI/CD workflow, contributing changes that increased team efficiency.

QA Test Lead | QA Analyst

Communication Services for the Deaf | Austin, TX

May 2013 to January 2015

Built the QA function for a video interpreting platform serving Deaf and hard-of-hearing users, immersing in the community to shape testing around real user needs.

- Learned American Sign Language and Deaf cultural norms to understand user needs firsthand, using that immersion as a user research approach that shaped requirements validation.
- Established the company's first-ever QA function, defining test procedures and quality benchmarks that caught non-functional code blocking release.
- Owned validation across web and mobile, from test planning through stakeholder reporting.
- Expanded test coverage to previously unreachable environments by implementing a VirtualBox-based cross-platform solution.

Lead QA Tester | Quality Assurance Tester

DocbookMD | Austin, TX

July 2012 to April 2013

Founded the QA function for a HIPAA-compliant healthcare messaging app, establishing regulatory-grade quality processes and validation strategy from zero.

- Analyzed and documented HIPAA compliance requirements, ensuring the app met regulatory standards for secure transmission of patient health information.
- Built the initial test strategy and QA documentation from scratch, gating releases against both business and HIPAA compliance requirements.
- Ran functional, regression, and HIPAA compliance validation across all supported mobile devices, creatively simulating wifi outages to catch edge cases scripted testing misses.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Test Lead QA Tester	<i>Luna Data Solutions</i>	(2011–2012)
Game Master Customer Experience & Trust Specialist	<i>Blizzard Entertainment</i>	(2010–2011)
QA Analyst Support Tools Developer Community Operations	<i>Linden Lab</i>	(2007–2010)
QA Tester	<i>Super Happy Fun Fun</i>	(2006–2007)
QA Test Lead, QA Game Tester	<i>Aspyr Media</i>	(2006–2006)

EDUCATION

Austin Community College - Austin, TX

Certificate in American Sign Language
2015 – 2017

ASL School - Austin, TX

Certificate in American Sign Language
2008 – 2012

Vista College - Berkeley, CA

Video Editing and Life Drawing
2001 – 2002

A.I. of Houston - Houston, TX

Fine Art, Typography, Layout, 3D Max
1995 – 1996

San Jacinto College - Pasadena, TX

Computer Science, Fine Art
1993 – 1995

Online version: <https://johnesco.github.io/resume>